

Desmos Shortcut Guide

The built-in graphing calculator can solve roughly 80% of SAT math. Stop doing algebra by hand.

Core Moves

Goal	Type this / do this
Solve an equation	Move everything to one side or graph both sides as $y = \dots$ and click the intersection.
System of equations	Enter both equations on separate lines; click the intersection dot for (x, y) .
Quadratic vertex	Graph $y = ax^2+bx+c$, then click the turning point — Desmos labels (h, k) .
Roots / zeros	Graph the function and click each x-axis crossing.
y-intercept	Click where the graph hits the y-axis, or evaluate at $x = 0$.
Maximum / minimum	Click the peak or valley of the curve.

Sliders, Tables & Regression

Feature	How to use it
Sliders	Type an unknown letter (e.g. $y = ax + b$) and Desmos offers “add slider.” Drag to match a condition.
Tables	Click $+$ $\rightarrow$ table to enter data points; great for “which function fits” questions.
Line of best fit	In a table, type $y_1 \sim mx_1 + b$ to run a linear regression and read m and b .
Restrict a domain	Add $\{0 < x < 10\}$ after a function to graph only part of it.
Solve $f(x) = \text{value}$	Graph $y = f(x)$ and $y = \text{value}$; the intersection is your answer.

Time-Savers & Cautions

Tip	Why
Convert decimals to fractions	Click the answer in a list to toggle exact fraction form.
Use parentheses generously	$8^{(x+4)} \neq 8^x + 4$ — careless entry costs points.
Zoom to find hidden intersections	Some points sit off-screen; pinch / scroll to find them.
Don't over-rely on it	Reading the question correctly still matters most.